

At the start of the game, the players enter the dungeon and the DM describes what the characters can see. One player should draw a map from the DM's descriptions; that player is called the **mapper**. As the player characters move further into the dungeon, more and more of the dungeon is mapped. Eventually, the DM's map and the players' map will look more or less alike.

To avoid confusion, the players should select one player to speak for the entire group or **party**. That player is named the **caller**. When unusual situations occur, each player may want to say what his or her character is doing. The caller should make sure that he or she is accurately representing all the player characters' wishes. The caller is a mediator between the players and the DM, and should not judge what the player characters should do.

As details of the dungeon are revealed, the player characters will meet "monsters" which they will have to avoid, talk to, or fight. A **monster** is any animal, person, or supernatural creature that is not a player character. A monster may be a ferocious dragon or a humble merchant. For game purposes, any creature *not* a player character is a monster. Human monsters are often called non-player characters (or NPCs) to separate them from other monsters.

A meeting between player characters and monsters is called an **encounter**. During an adventure the player characters will also discover treasure and try to avoid dangerous traps as well as encounter monsters. Sometimes, of course, the player characters will have to fight monsters. Such a fight is referred to as a **melee**.

In D&D rules, player characters try to gain experience, which is earned as **experience points** (or **XP**). Experience points are given out by the DM at the end of each adventure. Player characters continue to gain experience points for each adventure they participate in. Although this rule book only explains the abilities of characters up to the third level of experience, further supplements will explain character levels up to 36th level.

Use of the Word "Level"

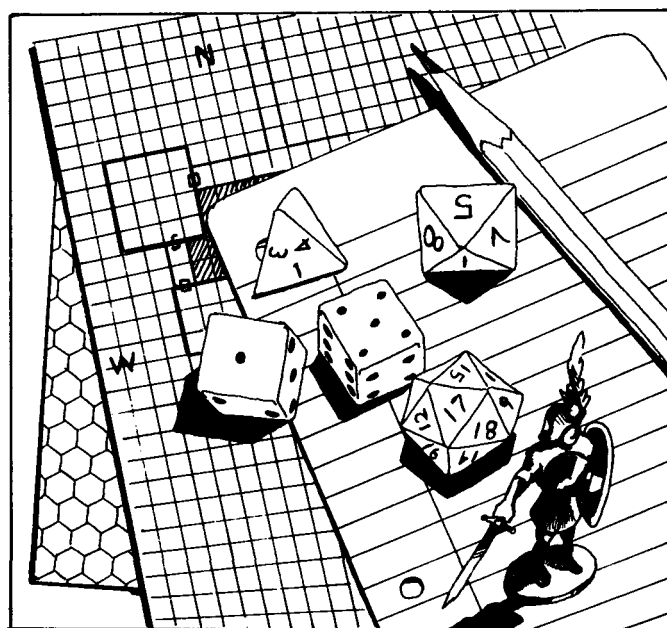
EXPERIENCE: The word "level" has several different meanings in D&D® Adventure Game. A "level of experience" is a general term meaning an amount of experience points. When a character earns a given amount of experience points (XP), that character gains one level of experience. **All player characters begin the game at the first level of experience**, and will gain levels of experience through adventures.

MONSTERS: A "monster level" indicates how tough and ferocious a type of monster is. A monster's level is equal to the number of **hit dice** (a measure of how much damage a monster can take and still survive; see **MONSTERS**, page B29) it has. Some monsters have special powers and the DM may consider them one "monster level" (or hit die) higher than the number of their hit dice.

SPELLS: The term "spell level" indicates the difficulty of a magic spell. For example, **light** is a first level spell, but **continual light** (a more difficult version of **light**) is a second level spell.

DUNGEONS: "Dungeon level" is used to refer to the depth of one floor of a dungeon, and gives an idea of how difficult the dungeon area is. For example, the 3rd level of a dungeon would mostly contain monsters with 3 hit dice, but the 1st level of a dungeon would mostly contain easier (1 hit die) monsters.

These uses of the word "level" will become quite familiar to the players once they have played a few games.



How To Use the Dice

In D&D rules, many different kinds of dice are used to give a variety of results. Though these dice appear strange at first, they will quickly become a familiar part of the game. Dice included in this set are a 4-sided die, a 6-sided die, an 8-sided die, a 10-sided die, a 12-sided die, and a 20-sided die. For easy reading, all of the dice are marked with numbers instead of pips (dots).

When referring to dice, an abbreviation is often used. The first number in the abbreviation is the number of dice to be rolled, followed by the letter "d" (short for die or dice), and then a number for the type of dice used. For example, 5d8 means an 8-sided die thrown 5 times, and would generate a total from 5 to 40.

The d4 looks like a pyramid. The best way to "throw" or roll a 4-sided die is to spin it and toss it straight up. It will land on one face (side) with three faces showing. The bottom number on each of the three faces is the same; this number is the result of the throw.

The other dice are rolled normally and the top face gives the result. The 0 on the d10 is read as "10". The d10 can also be used to generate a percentage (a number from 1 to 100). To do so, roll the d10 twice: the first roll gives the "tens" number, and the second roll gives the "ones" number. For example, a roll of 5 followed by a roll of 3 would be read as 53. A roll of 0 followed by another roll of 0 equals 100. Generating a number from 1 to 100 will be referred to as rolling **percentage dice** (or **d%**).

How To "Win":

"Winning" and "losing", things important to most games, do *not* apply to D&D games! The DM and the players do not play against each other, even though the DM often plays the role of various monsters which threaten the player characters. The DM must not take sides. He or she is a guide and a referee, the person who keeps the action flowing and creates an exciting adventure. Player characters have fun by overcoming fantastic obstacles and winning treasure, but this does not end the game. Nor is the game "lost" when an unlucky player's character dies, since the player may simply "roll up" a new character and continue playing. A good D&D campaign is similar to the creation of a fantasy novel, written by the DM and the players.